

As of the first quarter of 2016, Facebook has surpassed 1.6 billion users. That's more than 1.6 billion dynamically generated pages on one website alone. Now compound this to the fact that the number of websites crossed 1 billion way back in 2014. It doesn't take a genius to see that the internet is the second largest thing we know of, after the universe.

On occasion, it so happens that you want some information from that collection of things. On more often occasion, you don't know exactly what you want yourself. Of course, you might say, this is obvious, since no one can know everything and moreover, things change. Nowadays it's not even a problem. Everyone knows what to do when you need to find what you don't know you want... you Google it! (Colloquially speaking.) You put in any term related to what you want to find and you are served relevant results on a platter. The relevance is especially important, it is the crux of the usability and utility of search engines. In fact, it is only because search results are so good, that this joke works:

Q - Where is the best place to hide a dead body?

A - On the second page of Google search results.

So now the question becomes, how do these search engines find what you're looking for with such accuracy? Search engines essentially index the haystack to find the needle, but of course it's slightly more complicated than that. Shortly, we will see in more detail.

You want to be the needle that's found in the haystack of the internet? To be more realistic, you want to be the needle that's found in the needlestack of internet size? Isn't it too much to ask? Fortunately, there's a pseudo-magic pill for your website to take. You guessed it! The answer is SEO, search engine optimization!

The VVWorld Wide Web

So here's the field - the collection of all that is contained within what is commonly called 'the internet'. Indeed, it is very vastly wide, though that's not the same as what the 'wide' in www implies. That's the Very Vastly Wide World Wide Web.

To a layman, or an engineer, the internet is simply a network of networks of networks of... of computers. Computers are at the end points, be they massive farms of servers, or clients like your laptop, mobile phone or Xbox.